usually is) enclosed in parentheses. The argument list may be replaced by one for more forwarding markers, which can be a plain *, **, &, or ... without an argument name.

A positional argument is a local variable name, optionally followed by an equals sign and an expression defining a default value. The expression is evaluated at the time the method is called. If there are multiple arguments with default expressions, the expressions are evaluated from left to right. An expression may reference a argument that precedes it in the argument list.

```
def options(a = 99, b = a + 1)
  [a, b]
end
options       # => [99, 100]
options(1)    # => [1, 2]
options(2, 4) # => [2, 4]
```

Arguments without default values may appear after arguments with defaults. When such a method is called, Ruby will use the default values only if fewer parameters are passed to the method call than the total number of arguments.

```
def mixed(a, b = 50, c = b + 10, d)
  [a, b, c, d]
end
mixed(1, 2)       # => [1, 50, 60, 2]
mixed(1, 2, 3)    # => [1, 2, 12, 3]
mixed(1, 2, 3, 4) # => [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

As with parallel assignment, one of the arguments may start with an asterisk. If the method call specifies any parameters in excess of the regular argument count, all these extra parameters will be collected into this newly created array.

```
def varargs(a, *b)
  [a, b]
end
varargs(1)       # => [1, []]
varargs(1, 2)    # => [1, [2]]
varargs(1, 2, 3) # => [1, [2, 3]]
```

This argument need not be the last in the argument list. See the description of parallel assignment to see how values are assigned to this parameter.

```
def splat(first, *middle, last)
  [first, middle, last]
end
splat(1, 2)       # => [1, [], 2]
splat(1, 2, 3)    # => [1, [2], 3]
splat(1, 2, 3, 4) # => [1, [2, 3], 4]
```

If an array argument follows arguments with default values, parameters will first be used to override the defaults. The remainder will then be used to populate the array.

```
def mixed(a, b = 99, *c)
  [a, b, c]
end
mixed(1)          # => [1, 99, []]
mixed(1, 2)       # => [1, 2, []]
```